

LIVED EXPERIENCES OF COLLEGE STUDENTS IN REQUESTING ACADEMIC CONSULTATION

A Research Paper Presented to the Faculty of ABC College
In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for Practical Research

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May 2026

APPROVAL SHEET

This research paper entitled LIVED EXPERIENCES OF COLLEGE STUDENTS IN REQUESTING ACADEMIC CONSULTATION prepared by Ana M. Dela Cruz, Mark R. Garcia, Lea P. Mendoza has been examined and recommended for acceptance and approval.

Adviser: _____

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The researchers sincerely acknowledge the guidance of their adviser, the suggestions of the panel members, and the cooperation of the respondents or participants who contributed their time. The researchers also thank their families and classmates for their encouragement, technical support, and assistance during data gathering, writing, and final preparation of the manuscript.

ABSTRACT

This qualitative study explored the lived experiences of college students in requesting academic consultation. The study used a phenomenological research design. Ten (10) college students were selected through criterion purposive sampling. Data were gathered using a semi-structured interview guide and analyzed through thematic analysis. The findings revealed communication barriers, self-managed coping, and the need for structured support.

Keywords: consultation, academic support, usability, student experience, research

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

Introduction

Academic consultation is an important support activity because it gives students an opportunity to seek guidance from faculty members. Through consultation, students can clarify requirements, ask questions, and receive direction for academic tasks.

Qualitative research is useful for this topic because the concern involves student experiences, feelings, challenges, and coping practices. Instead of measuring only satisfaction levels, this study seeks to understand what students actually experience.

Background of the Study

Students may experience uncertainty when consultation requests are handled through informal messages or unstructured arrangements. Some may wait for confirmation, ask classmates for updates, send repeated follow-up messages, or miss consultation opportunities because the process is unclear.

Although digital systems and appointment platforms have been studied in relation to access and convenience (Atherton et al., 2024; Ostadmohammadi et al., 2025), fewer studies focus on how students personally experience consultation scheduling in a local college context.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to explore the lived experiences of college students in requesting academic consultation. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

- What are the lived experiences of college students in requesting academic consultation?
- What challenges do students encounter during the consultation request process?
- How do students cope with these challenges?
- What support do students need to improve the consultation process?

Objectives of the Study

The general objective of this study is to explore the lived experiences of college students in requesting academic consultation. Specifically, it aims to describe experiences, identify challenges, examine coping strategies, and determine support needs.

Research Assumption

This qualitative study does not use a statistical hypothesis. It assumes that students with direct consultation experiences can provide meaningful descriptions of the process.

Significance of the Study

This study is significant to students, faculty members, administrators, and future researchers. Students may benefit from clearer consultation support. Faculty members may benefit from improved schedule monitoring. Administrators may use the findings as basis for improving academic support services. Future researchers may use this study as a reference.

Scope and Delimitations

This study focuses on academic consultation in a college setting during academic year 2026. It covers consultation scheduling, student-faculty interaction, and user experience related to the consultation process. It does not include enrollment systems, grading systems, payment systems, or long-term academic performance outcomes.

Limitations of the Study

The study may be limited by the number of available respondents or participants, the honesty of responses, and the specific setting where the study is conducted.

Definition of Terms

Term	Definition in the Study
Academic Consultation	A scheduled or requested interaction between a student and faculty member for academic support.
Consultation System	A platform or process used to manage consultation requests, schedules, and records.
Usability	The degree to which a system is easy, efficient, learnable, and satisfactory to use.
Student Experience	The thoughts, feelings, challenges, and actions of students during consultation requests.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

Introduction

This chapter presents literature, studies, theory, framework, synthesis, and research gap related to academic consultation, appointment scheduling, usability, and student support.

Related Literature

Academic consultation is part of student support because it allows learners to receive feedback and guidance from faculty members. In technology-supported environments, appointment systems can reduce uncertainty by making schedules visible and by providing clear status updates.

Usability is important when evaluating a digital system. A system may contain useful features, but if users find it confusing, slow, or difficult to navigate, the system may not be adopted successfully.

Related Studies

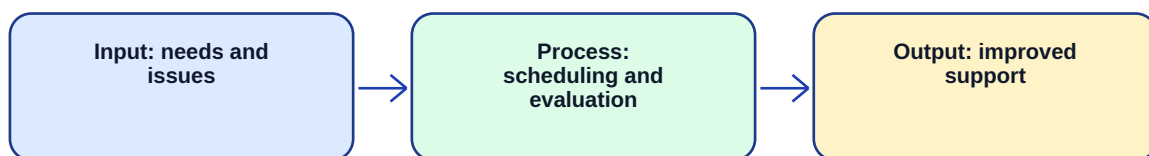
Studies on electronic appointment systems show that online scheduling can improve user access, reduce waiting uncertainty, and support better coordination between users and service providers (Ala & Chen, 2022; Betancor et al., 2025).

Theoretical Framework

The Technology Acceptance Model supports system-related research because it explains that perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use influence user acceptance. For qualitative student-support research, social support theory may guide interpretation.

Conceptual Framework

Figure 2.1 Conceptual Framework



The framework shows that consultation problems and user needs serve as input. The process includes scheduling, communication, data gathering, and evaluation. The output is an improved understanding or improved system.

Synthesis

The reviewed literature and studies show that academic consultation is an important support process and that digital appointment systems can improve access and organization. However, there remains a need for studies that focus specifically on student-faculty consultation in a local academic setting.

Research Gap

The gap addressed by this study is the limited focus on academic consultation management in local college settings. This study contributes by focusing on consultation usability and student experience.

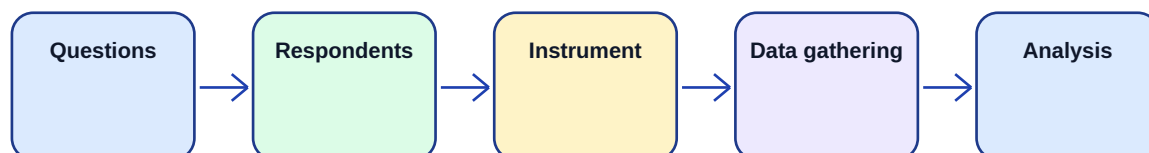
CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research Design

This study uses a phenomenological qualitative research design because it aims to explore and describe the lived experiences of students in requesting academic consultation.

Figure 3.1 Methodology Flow



Research Locale

The study will be conducted at ABC College, an academic institution where students regularly seek consultation from faculty members.

Respondents / Participants

The participants will be ten (10) college students who have experienced requesting academic consultation.

Sampling Technique

Purposive sampling will be used because the study requires individuals who have direct experience with the topic.

Research Instrument

The research instrument will be a semi-structured interview guide with open-ended questions about student experiences, challenges, coping strategies, and support needs.

Interview Question	Purpose
Can you describe your experience when requesting consultation?	Get the lived experience.
What challenges did you encounter?	Identify difficulties.
How did you handle these challenges?	Identify coping strategies.
What support would make consultation easier?	Identify recommendations.

Validation of Instrument

The instrument will be reviewed by research and subject-matter experts. Validators will check clarity, relevance, organization, and alignment with the research questions.

Data Gathering Procedure

Figure 3.3 Data Gathering Procedure



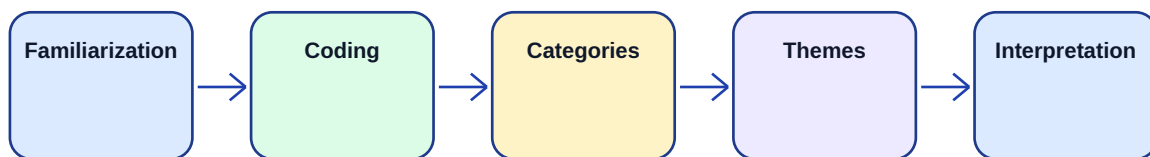
The researchers will first request permission from the school. After approval, respondents or participants will be informed about the purpose of the study. Data will then be gathered using the appropriate instrument.

Ethical Considerations

Participation will be voluntary. Respondents and participants will be informed about the purpose of the study, their right to withdraw, and the confidentiality of their responses.

Data Analysis

Figure 3.4 Thematic Analysis Flow



Step	Description
Familiarization	Read transcripts repeatedly.
Coding	Label meaningful statements.
Categorization	Group related codes.
Theme Development	Form major themes.
Interpretation	Explain the meaning of themes.

CHAPTER 4

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS, AND INTERPRETATION OF DATA

Introduction

This chapter presents the results of the study based on the order of the research questions. Each table, graph, or theme is followed by analysis and interpretation.

Participant Profile

Participant Code	Year Level	Consultation Experience
P1	First Year	Requested consultation for coursework
P2	Second Year	Requested consultation for research
P3	Third Year	Requested project guidance
P4-P10	Various	Experienced consultation scheduling

Theme 1: Communication Barriers

Codes	Theme	Interpretation
Delayed replies, no confirmation, unclear communication	Communication Barriers	Students experienced uncertainty when consultation requests were not confirmed or received delayed responses.

Several participants described waiting for replies or being unsure whether their consultation request had been accepted. This theme shows that unclear communication can discourage students from seeking academic support.

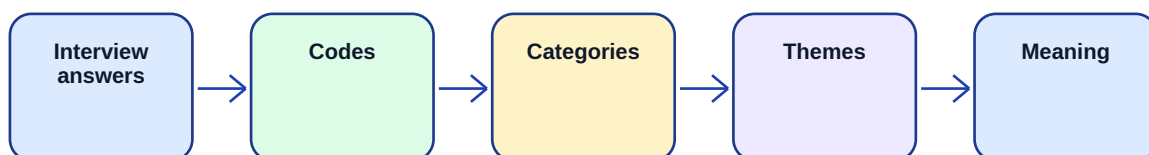
Theme 2: Self-Managed Coping

Codes	Theme	Interpretation
Asking classmates, sending follow-up messages, creating a log for questions	Self-Managed Coping	Students created strategies to manage uncertainty and seek support from peers.

Theme 3: Need for Structured Support

Codes	Theme	Interpretation
Official booking, visible schedule, notification for structured support	Need for Structured Support	Students preferred an organized system with clear scheduling and communication channels.

Figure 4.1 Qualitative Analysis Output



Discussion of Findings

The findings support the idea that academic consultation can be improved through clearer communication and structured scheduling. High usability ratings or clear qualitative themes show that students and faculty members need an organized

consultation process.

CHAPTER 5

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Summary of the Study

This study explored the lived experiences of college students in requesting academic consultation. It used a phenomenological qualitative design and thematic analysis.

Summary of Findings

- Students experienced communication barriers such as delayed replies and unclear confirmation.
- Students coped by asking classmates, sending follow-up messages, and waiting for responses.
- Students preferred visible schedules, official booking, and notifications.

Conclusions

Students value academic consultation but experience difficulty when the process lacks clear communication and structured scheduling. A more organized process can help students access faculty support more confidently.

Recommendations

- Schools may adopt clearer consultation scheduling procedures.
- Faculty members may provide visible consultation availability and timely confirmation.
- Developers may improve notification features, mobile responsiveness, and calendar integration.
- Future researchers may conduct wider studies using larger samples, mixed methods, or different academic settings.

Action Plan

Objective	Activity	Responsible	Timeframe	Expected Output
Improve scheduling clarity	Using official booking channel	School / Faculty	1 month	Clearer consultation process
Improve notifications	Add real-time alerts	Developers	1 month	Better status visibility
Expand evaluation	Conduct wider testing	Researchers	2 months	More reliable findings

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APPENDICES

Appendix A. Letter of Permission

A formal permission letter may be attached here to show that the researchers requested approval before conducting data gathering.

Appendix B. Research Instrument

Interview Question	Purpose
Describe your experience in requesting academic consultation.	Gather consultation experience.
What challenges did you encounter?	Identify barriers.
How did you cope with these challenges?	Identify coping strategies.
What support do you need?	Develop recommendations.

Appendix C. Validation Form

This appendix may include expert validation ratings and comments for the research instrument.

Appendix D. Sample Computation or Coding Matrix

For quantitative research, attach sample weighted mean computation. For qualitative research, attach a coding matrix showing codes, categories, and themes.

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